



# Things you should consider before buying a laptop

Come festive season and we all run to grab the best deals and discounts on offer. The laptop sales sky rocket during this time as most of us wait for deals to go live. Before you hastily make a purchase decision based on the amount of free goodies, we recommend reading through the laptop buying guide below.

## Which processor?

For some, this might be the most important parameter to look at, while for the rest not quite as much. If you're a light to moderate laptop user, it's best to go for a Core i3 2310M processor as most of your work would comprise of editing and creating text documents and Excel sheets, and surfing the web. If you are a light gamer and also do some video or photo editing then the Core i5 2430M should be the minimum (with an appropriate graphics card). For hardcore gamers and geeks we recommend the Core i7 2670QM to match their demanding graphics and computing needs.



## Keyboard



This might not strike you as an important factor to look at, but most of the dust attracted by your laptop accumulates in between the keys. A chiclet keyboard adds a refreshing look and feel to your machine while doing with any dust particles, apart from being great to type on. But this is a subjective choice; test-drive your prospective laptop's keyboard before purchasing it.

## USB 3.0

With a transfer rate of about 480 MB per second, USB 3.0 is the future. Make sure your machine ships with at least one port to future-proof the laptop.



## Screen size

The screen size of your laptop dictates how portable your machine is, as it directly impacts its overall weight. The bigger the screen, the more difficult it is to move about with. If



15-inch display measured diagonally

accurate colour representation matters to you a lot, then look for an RGB LED backlit screen which should ensure a whiter and richer colour experience. A good full HD 1080P display is what you should be looking at, but laptops with such screens are generally

## SSD or HDD

This has been the subject of quite some debate over the past few months. The decision to choose between an SSD or HDD solely depends on how much you're willing to spend on your laptop. While

regular HDD prices are falling each day, having one in your machine doesn't future proof it. SSDs are more reliable and quicker, but are more expensive than HDDs. This decision is yours to make.



## Weight / build quality

More important factors to look at are the weight of the laptop, overall form factor and durability. Of course your machine shouldn't be built like a tank, but then it shouldn't be too fragile either. Look for a sturdy chassis which will last you till your next laptop upgrade.

## Battery life

A lot depends on the hardware that effects your battery life. An average set up ships with a 6 cell battery which would give you run time of about 2-3 hours under normal usage. However if you up your budget by a few thousands you can opt for a 9 cell or a 12 cell battery which would just double your juice



A nine cell battery is wider and bulkier than a six cell



## Do I need Windows at all?

Not really; if you're a Linux fanboy then you wouldn't need it. Opting for Linux will surely save you money which you can invest in upgrading your hardware. Be sure before opting for this route, you'll be putting food on some Open-Source developer's table, which is a good thing.